

Meeting Summary — September 1, 2026

Participants: Thomas Abshier, Isak Gutierrez **Duration:** ~2 hours (6:26–8:38 AM)

Decisions Made

1. **Trading scaled back to “penny poker”** — one contract per day, let it ride to EOD, don’t watch it. Thomas made \$34, Isak made \$20. Both agree it’s entertainment, not income.
2. **Joelle hired** — Thomas hired her. Role: Isak’s assistant (similar to what Cayenne was supposed to be, but Joelle has business maturity to grasp the big picture).
3. **Two-track product strategy proposed** (not finalized):
 - **New LiftWalker** → sell to clinics/facilities at ~\$7,000 direct
 - **Traveler** → sell to individuals for home use at \$16,000 (or \$12,000) through DME/prescription path
 - Thomas wants these to be genuinely different products to be defensible under audit

Key Discussions

Charlie’s Two-Tier Email

Charlie proposed two versions of the LiftWalker (basic non-disassemblable vs deluxe with accessories). Thomas’s concern: cosmetic differentiation (colors, accessories) isn’t enough — it looks like the same product at two prices, which creates audit risk. Thomas suggested the real differentiator should be structural (e.g., hydraulic vs motorized lift).

Making the LiftWalker Shippable

Thomas proposed a rod-clamp assembly system so the LiftWalker can ship disassembled and be assembled once by the customer (“some assembly required” — not designed for repeated breakdown like the Traveler). This would solve the storage and shipping cost problems that make the LiftWalker expensive to sell at \$6–7k.

Action: Isak to talk to Charlie and Leonard about maximum disassembly possible with the current LiftWalker frame design.

Walker vs Transfer Device (Regulatory)

Thomas sees the product primarily as a transfer device (especially toileting). Isak laid out the regulatory implications: - **Walker (ITJ):** minimal GMP burden, current classification - **Transfer/patient lift (FSA):** 20–35 documented procedures, full quality system - **Key insight from competitors:** Biodex threads the needle — markets caregiver safety benefits (“no patient lifting required”) while classifying as a powered exerciser (BxB), not a patient lift. Rifton collapsed their dedicated transfer device (TRAM) into the E-Pacer gait trainer line in June 2025 — moving toward walker positioning. - **Recommendation holds:** classify as walker, market transfer benefits in demos/videos without making it the regulatory identity.

Competitor Pricing Reality Check

All competitors price between \$5,670 and \$12,878. At \$16,000, the Traveler is the most expensive device in the category. Thomas raised serious concern about doctor willingness to prescribe at that price point when alternatives exist.

DME economics at different MSRPs: | MSRP | Medicaid pays (75%) | DME keeps (30%) | Ideomotion gets | Minus COGS (\$3,500) | Profit | ————|—————|—————|—————
—————|———| \$6,000 | \$4,500 | \$1,350 | \$3,150 | -\$350 | **Loss** || \$12,000 | \$9,000 | \$2,700 |
\$6,300 | \$2,800 | **Viable** || \$16,000 | \$12,000 | \$3,600 | \$8,400 | \$4,900 | **Best margin** |

The Core Sales Problem

Thomas articulated the fundamental challenge: “We’re talking about creating a new medical paradigm. Nobody believes that someone in a wheelchair could learn to walk. You see a person in a wheelchair, you think ‘that person can’t walk.’ I would never think otherwise.”

Charlie's sales approach (therapy demonstrations showing wheelchair users they have muscle strength) works in person but is hard to scale. Competitors are well-established with documentation, supply pipelines, advertising, and staffing. "We have a dream. That's what we got."

Action Items

#	Item	Owner	Status
1	Talk to Charlie + Leonard about max disassembly for LiftWalker shipping	Isak	Open
2	Get LiftWalker CAD drawings organized with Leonard	Isak	Open
3	Talk to Charlie + Victory Circle about LiftWalker manufacturing cost at disassemblable spec	Isak	Open
4	Define Joelle's role and initial tasks	Thomas + Isak	Open
5	Decide on pricing strategy: \$12k vs \$16k MSRP for DME channel	Thomas + Charlie + Isak	Open
6	Decide on product differentiation approach (structural vs cosmetic) between LiftWalker and Traveler	All	Open

Open Questions

- Can the LiftWalker be made shippable without fundamentally redesigning it?
- Is \$12,000 the right MSRP for the DME/prescription channel? (viable margin, competitive with field)
- Does the two-track strategy (clinic direct + individual prescription) hold up under Robinson-Patman / audit scrutiny?
- Should the LiftWalker use a hydraulic lift instead of motorized to create genuine product differentiation?
- What exactly will Joelle's day-to-day tasks look like?